GROWTHSPRING INVESTMENT CLUB CONSTITUTION

Article 1: Name and Registered Address

1.1 The Club shall be known as **GrowthSpring Investment Club** (the "Club").
1.2 The Club's office shall be situated in **Kampala**, or any other place determined by members from time to time.
1.3 The Club's postal address shall be **P.O. Box 20, Jinja**, or any other address determined by members from time to time.

Article 2: Nature of the Club

2.1 The Club is a member-based savings, loans, and investment club formed to improve members' socio-economic welfare through disciplined saving, responsible borrowing, and joint investment.

Article 3: Mission

3.1 The mission of the Club is:
To improve members' socio-economic welfare through collective saving and investing, and through a savings-and-loans scheme that provides **accessible and flexible credit services**, so that every member thrives.

Article 4: Objectives

The objectives of the Club are to:
4.1 Encourage a disciplined habit of saving and investing among members.
4.2 Provide members with easy and timely access to credit.
4.3 Promote unity, cooperation, and professional networking among members.
4.4 Invest Club surplus funds in ways approved through the Club's governance organs.
4.5 Support members financially and materially during times of need, according to Club rules.
4.6 Acquire, own, and dispose of property in the name of the Club, when properly approved.
4.7 Provide guidance, counselling, and professional support that improves members' social and economic welfare.

Article 5: Key Definitions

In this Constitution, unless the context requires otherwise:
5.1 **General Assembly** means all fully registered members meeting together to make decisions.
5.2 **Admin Team** means the Club's leadership responsible for day-to-day operations.
5.3 **Savings Fund** means pooled member savings used mainly for member loans and related

activities.
5.4 **Club Fund** means the Club's operations, welfare, and stabilization fund.
5.5 **Financial Policy** means the Club's approved policy document that contains financial rules, figures, formulas, and procedures (including Savings & Loans, Land, and Admin Compensation).
5.6 **AGM** in this Constitution refers to the Club's official General Assembly meetings held twice a year.

Article 6: Membership

6.1 Eligibility and Admission

6.1.1 Membership is **by invitation only**.
6.1.2 A prospective member becomes a fully registered member only after:
(a) verification and acceptance under procedures approved by the Club; and
(b) payment of any membership fee approved by the Club.
6.1.3 The Club shall maintain an official **Register of Members**. A new member shall be entered only after meeting admission requirements.

6.2 Member Obligations

Each member shall:
6.2.1 Save consistently by depositing money into approved Club accounts (bank and/or mobile money).
6.2.2 Provide proof of payment (bank slip, mobile money confirmation, or other approved evidence) for accurate records.
6.2.3 Meet the minimum saving expectations set out in the **Financial Policy**.
6.2.4 Follow the Constitution, Club policies, and lawful decisions made through proper meetings.
6.2.5 Declare and keep updated their **next of kin** details.
6.2.6 Attend at least **one General Assembly meeting each year**, physically or online.

6.3 Member Rights

Every fully registered member has the right to:
6.3.1 Participate in meetings and vote (subject to quorum and meeting rules).
6.3.2 Access Club reports and information according to approved transparency rules.
6.3.3 Apply for loans and other member services according to the **Financial Policy**.
6.3.4 Be treated fairly and be heard in any disciplinary process.

Article 7: Cessation, Resignation, Suspension, and Expulsion

7.1 Ways Membership May End

7.1.1 Membership may end through resignation, suspension, expulsion, death, or loss of legal capacity.

7.2 Resignation

7.2.1 A member may resign by giving **written notice** to the Secretary and completing the Club's **Withdrawal Form**.
7.2.2 A resigned member may be readmitted only if approved under the Club's admission rules and conditions set by the General Assembly.

7.3 Suspension

7.3.1 The General Assembly may suspend a member by a **two-thirds (2/3) majority vote** at a properly convened meeting.
7.3.2 Reasons for suspension must be given, and the member must be allowed a fair chance to respond.

7.4 Expulsion

7.4.1 A member may be expelled for gross misconduct or actions that seriously harm the Club.
7.4.2 Expulsion must be approved by the General Assembly by a **two-thirds (2/3) majority vote** at a properly convened meeting.
7.4.3 The member has the right to defend themselves before a final decision is made.

7.5 Exit Benefits and Liabilities

7.5.1 When a member leaves, their name shall be removed from the Register after completing the exit process.
7.5.2 An exiting member is entitled to receive:
(a) their savings and any returns due to them; **minus**
(b) unpaid loans, obligations, and liabilities, as guided by the **Financial Policy** and Club records.
7.5.3 Upon exit, the member forfeits future membership privileges and benefits reserved for continuing members.
7.5.4 The Club may apply an orderly exit process (including scheme transfers/auctions where applicable) as defined in the **Financial Policy**, to protect continuity and prevent destabilizing Club investments.

Article 8: Governance and Decision-Making

8.1 The General Assembly (Supreme Organ)

8.1.1 The General Assembly is the highest decision-making body of the Club.
8.1.2 The Club shall hold **two General Assembly meetings per year**.
8.1.3 Each member shall attend at least one such meeting each year, physically or online.

8.2 Functions of the General Assembly

The General Assembly shall:
8.2.1 Approve Club policies (including the Financial Policy) and major changes to them.
8.2.2 Elect or confirm leadership as provided by this Constitution.
8.2.3 Receive and approve financial and accountability reports.
8.2.4 Approve major investment decisions and strategic directions.
8.2.5 Resolve disputes escalated to it.
8.2.6 Approve partnerships that significantly affect the Club.
8.2.7 Provide oversight over the Admin Team.

8.3 Quorum and Voting

8.3.1 Quorum for a General Assembly meeting shall be **two-thirds (2/3) of registered members**.
8.3.2 Unless otherwise stated in this Constitution, decisions shall be made by **simple majority** of those present and voting.
8.3.3 Where votes are equal, the Chairperson shall have a casting vote.

Article 9: Leadership Structure (Admin Team Departments)

9.1 The Club's day-to-day management shall be organized into the following departments:
(a) Executive Department (Chairman)
(b) Finance & Treasury Department
(c) Operations & Member Welfare (HR & Communications / Secretary Function)
(d) IT & Systems Department
(e) Media & Public Relations Department

Article 10: Roles and Responsibilities (Admin Team)

10.1 The detailed duties of each department and officer shall be as described in the **Financial Policy** and any approved internal procedures, provided they remain consistent with this Constitution.

Article 11: Elections and Leadership Changes

11.1 Only fully registered members may vote or hold leadership roles.
11.2 Elections shall be conducted under procedures approved by the General Assembly.
11.3 Quorum for elections shall be **two-thirds (2/3)** of registered members.
11.4 Voting shall be by secret ballot unless the meeting approves another transparent method.
11.5 Virtual voting may be used if approved procedures exist.
11.6 Where a position becomes vacant, the Club may hold a by-election or use an interim method approved by the General Assembly until the next meeting.

Article 12: Meetings

12.1 The Admin Team shall meet at least once every month, or as needed.
12.2 General Assembly meetings shall be held **twice a year**.
12.3 Meetings may be held physically or online. Voting may be physical or virtual under approved procedures.

Article 13: Financial Structure

13.1 Savings Fund (Core Principle)

13.1.1 The Club shall maintain a **Savings Fund** made up of members' savings contributions.
13.1.2 **Savings in the Savings Fund are not withdrawable for normal use.**
13.1.3 A member may only withdraw their Savings Fund savings **when exiting the Club**, subject to the exit process.
13.1.4 If a member needs to make use of funds while still a member, it shall be done **only through loans** issued under the Financial Policy, and **all loans must be repaid**.

13.2 Club Fund (Core Principle)

13.2.1 The Club shall maintain a **Club Fund** to run operations, support member welfare, and stabilize the Club when risks occur.
13.2.2 Sources, uses, and protections for the Club Fund shall be governed by the **Financial Policy**.

13.3 Schemes and Investments

13.3.1 The Club may operate additional schemes and investments (including land) approved by the General Assembly.
13.3.2 Detailed rules for schemes shall be in the **Financial Policy**.

Article 14: Records, Accounts, and Controls

14.1 The Club shall keep proper financial records and evidence for each transaction.
14.2 All Club money shall be deposited promptly into approved accounts.
14.3 Payment approvals, signatories, and withdrawal controls shall be defined in the **Financial Policy** to protect members and ensure transparency.

Article 15: Audit and Financial Year

15.1 The Club shall keep proper books of account and supporting evidence.
15.2 The General Assembly may appoint an auditor or independent reviewer as needed.
15.3 The financial year shall run from **1 January to 31 December**.

Article 16: Property and Safe Custody

16.1 Official Club documents and records shall be kept under the Operations/Secretary function with secure backups managed by IT.
16.2 Any property acquired belongs to the Club and must be recorded clearly, including the scheme/fund it relates to.

Article 17: Amendments to the Constitution

17.1 This Constitution may be amended by a **two-thirds (2/3) majority** of members present and voting at a properly convened General Assembly meeting with quorum.
17.2 Proposed amendments must be shared with members in advance in writing, including the full text.
17.3 Amendments take effect after approval and formal recording.

Article 18: Dissolution

18.1 The Club may only be dissolved by a special resolution passed by at least a **two-thirds (2/3) majority** of members present and voting at a properly convened General Assembly meeting with quorum.
18.2 On dissolution, liabilities and closure costs must be settled first.
18.3 Remaining balances and assets shall be distributed fairly according to Club records and the dissolution rules in the **Financial Policy**.

Article 19: Adoption

19.1 This Constitution is adopted by the members of GrowthSpring Investment Club and shall take effect from the date it is approved and recorded by the Club.
